

Unless, as long as, provided that

CEFR B1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

These linkers add a condition, like 'if', but with a twist:

- 1 Unless = if not / except if — I won't call unless it's urgent.
- 2 As long as / provided that = only on this condition — You can borrow it as long as you return it.

Use the same tenses as with 'if': present simple after these words for a real future. Don't add a second 'not' after 'unless'.

At a glance

Linker	Meaning	Example
unless	if not / except if	I won't go unless you come.
as long as	only on this condition	You can stay as long as you're quiet.
provided / providing that	only if (more formal)	You'll pass provided that you revise.
in case	as a precaution	Take an umbrella in case it rains.

Learning objectives

- Can use 'unless' to mean 'if not / except if' (CEFR B1).
- Can use 'as long as' and 'provided/providing that' to state conditions.
- Can avoid double negatives after 'unless'.



Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Unless, as long as, provided that · CEFR B1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. ____ you hurry, you'll miss the bus.

- | | |
|------------------|---------------|
| A. Unless | B. As long as |
| C. Provided that | D. In case |

2. You can borrow my car ____ you drive carefully.

- | | |
|------------|---------------|
| A. unless | B. as long as |
| C. in case | D. so that |

3. Take an umbrella ____ it rains later.

- | | |
|------------|------------------|
| A. unless | B. as long as |
| C. in case | D. provided that |

4. Rewrite: 'If you don't book now, you won't get a seat.'

- | | |
|---|---|
| A. Unless you book now, you won't get a seat. | B. Unless you don't book now, you won't get a seat. |
| C. As long as you book now, you won't get a seat. | D. In case you book now, you won't get a seat. |

5. We'll start on Monday ____ everyone agrees.

- | | |
|------------|------------------|
| A. unless | B. provided that |
| C. in case | D. even if |

6. Fix this: 'Unless you don't call, I'll worry.'

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|-------------------------------------|--|
| A. Unless you call, I'll worry. | B. Unless you will call, I'll worry. |
| C. The sentence is already correct. | D. Unless you don't calling, I'll worry. |

7. You can stay out late ____ you text me when you arrive.

- | | |
|------------|---------------|
| A. unless | B. as long as |
| C. in case | D. otherwise |

8. I won't say anything ____ you want me to.

- | | |
|------------------|---------------|
| A. unless | B. as long as |
| C. provided that | D. in case |

9. Choose the correct verb: 'Provided that you ____ on time, you can join.'

- | | |
|-----------------|----------------|
| A. arrive | B. will arrive |
| C. would arrive | D. arrived |

10. What does 'You'll be fine as long as you stay calm' mean?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A. You'll be fine only on the condition that you stay calm. | B. You'll be fine even if you don't stay calm. |
| C. Stay calm in case you're fine. | D. You won't be fine if you stay calm. |

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. Unless** — 'Unless you hurry' = 'if you don't hurry'.
2. **B. as long as** — 'As long as' states the condition: 'as long as you drive carefully'.
3. **C. in case** — 'In case it rains' = as a precaution, take it now.
4. **A. Unless you book now, you won't get a seat.** — 'Unless you book now' = 'if you don't book now'.
5. **B. provided that** — 'Provided that everyone agrees' states the condition formally.
6. **A. Unless you call, I'll worry.** — 'Unless' already means 'if not', so drop the second negative: 'Unless you call'.
7. **B. as long as** — 'As long as you text me' states the strict condition.
8. **A. unless** — 'Unless you want me to' = 'except if you want me to'.
9. **A. arrive** — Use the present simple after these linkers: 'provided that you arrive on time'.
10. **A. You'll be fine only on the condition that you stay calm.** — 'As long as' = only on this condition: staying calm is what keeps you fine.